

Heeyoung Lee

He/Him

Department of Sociology

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Education

2021-Present	Ph.D. Candidate in Sociology, University at Albany, State University of New York, United States Dissertation: “Living Among the Educated: Human Capital Spillover and Educational Mortality Gaps in the United States (2010-2022)” [Chair: Tse-Chuan Yang]
2020	M.A. Sociology, Chung Ang University, Korea
2017	B.A. Sociology, Kyung Hee University, Korea

Academic Interests

Health Inequality | Crime and Deviance | Socioecological Approach | Life Course and Aging | Quantitative Methods | Spatial Analysis

Publications

Journal Articles (†equal 1st author; ‡corresponding author)

2026. Yeeun Hong and **Heeyoung Lee**^{†‡}, Selectivity, Assimilation, and the Limits of Education: Immigrant Mortality Trajectories Among Asian and Hispanic Populations in the US. *Sociology of Race and Ethnicity*. (Forthcoming)
2026. Tse-Chuan Yang, Carla Shoff, **Heeyoung Lee**, and Kiwoong Park, Research Note: Opioid Use Disorder Diagnosis during the COVID-19 Pandemic and Mortality Rates among Older Medicare Beneficiaries in the US. *Demography*. (Forthcoming)
2026. Matt Vogel, **Heeyoung Lee**, Taylor Kaser, and Yoobin Kim, Misappropriating Vulnerability: Assessing the Social Vulnerability Index as a Predictor of Firearm Violence. *PLOS One*. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0355673>
2026. **Heeyoung Lee**, Jungmin Shin[†], and Jonathan Dirlam, The Influence of Structural Sexism and the #MeToo Movement on Sexual Harassment Complaints in the United States. *The Sociological Quarterly*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/00380253.2026.2705576>
2026. Seong-Jo Jeong, Bomi Kim, **Heeyoung Lee**, and Hyemin Lee, Substance Use and Mental Health Outcomes among Gay and Bisexual Men in South Korea: A Cross-Sectional Study. *Addictive Behavior Report*. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.abrep.2026.100728>

2026. **Heeyoung Lee**, Permeable Boundaries: How Neighboring States' Policy Environments Shape Local Mortality Rates in the United States. *Journal of Health and Social Behavior*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/00221465261457832>
2026. Tse-Chuan Yang, **Heeyoung Lee**, and Golam Morshed Suhel, Age Segregation and Deaths of Despair among Older Adults, 2010-2022: Rural/Urban County Comparisons. *Social Science and Medicine*. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.socscimed.2026.119407>
2025. **Heeyoung Lee** and Tse-Chuan Yang, Unequal Spillover of Human Capital: Longitudinal Analysis of Mortality Among Populations by College Degree in US Counties, 2010-2022. *American Journal of Preventive Medicine*. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.amepre.2025.107646>
↳ *Related Report: How Does County Educational Composition Affect Mortality? Lerner Center Population Health Research Brief Series, Research Brief #139*
2025. **Heeyoung Lee** and Matt Vogel. Exposure to Police Killing and Adolescents' Self-Concept: Diverging Effects for Black and White American Youths. *Journal of Adolescence*. <https://doi.org/10.1002/jad.12490>
2025. **Heeyoung Lee** and Seong-Jo Jung. Gender Differences in the Relationship between Coming Out as LGB to Family and Depression in South Korea. *Society and Mental Health*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/21568693241242400>
↳ *2024 Paul Meadows, Excellence in Research Award Winner, Sociology Department, University at Albany, SUNY*
2025. Tse-Chuan Yang, Carla Shoff, Kate Strully, and **Heeyoung Lee**. Features of Residential Counties and Individual Health Conditions for Opioid Use Disorder Among Older Medicare Beneficiaries. *The Journals of Gerontology, Series B: Psychological Sciences and Social Sciences*. <https://doi.org/10.1093/geronb/gbaf069>
2025. Seong-Jo Jung, **Heeyoung Lee**, and Chan. S, Suh. Moving Apart and Coming Together: The Dynamics of Coalition Building in the Case of South Korean LGBTQ Movement. *Journal of Homosexuality*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/00918369.2024.2378743>
2024. **Heeyoung Lee** and Tse-Chuan Yang. Spatial and Temporal Dimension of Black-White Mental Health Paradox in the US: Effect of Cumulative Neighborhood Disadvantage. *Population Research & Policy Review*. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11113-024-09922-2>
2024. **Heeyoung Lee**. State-Level Structural Sexism and Adolescent Sexual Violence Victimization in the US. *Child Abuse and Neglect*. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chiabu.2024.107096>
2024. **Heeyoung Lee**. Delinquency During Puberty as a Biosocial Behavior: Time-Varying Effects of Social Contexts on Girl's Delinquency in South Korea. *Criminal Justice and Behaviors*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/00938548241276087>
↳ *2022 Paul Meadows, Excellence in Research Award Winner, Sociology Department, University at Albany, SUNY*
2024. **Heeyoung Lee**, Sooyeon Moon, and Na-Young Lee. Industry Culture Matters: Sexual Harassment in the South Korean Film Industry. *Violence Against Women*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/10778012231203001>

2023. Seong-Jo Jung and **Heeyoung Lee**. Open, Discreet, and Repressive Closet: Latent Class Analysis on the Patterns of LGBTQ+ Youth's Coming Out. *The Korean Journal of Sociology* [in Korean]
↳ 2023 Graduate Student Research Award, Sociology Department, Chung-Ang University
2021. **Heeyoung Lee**, Dawool Cheong, and Seoung-Jo Jung. A Democratic Response to COVID-19 or Governance with People Without Rights. *Memory & Vision* [in Korean]
↳ 2021 Democracy Academic Paper Contest Winner, Korean Democracy Foundation
↳ 2022 Academic Paper Award Winner, People's Solidarity for Participatory Democracy
2019. **Heeyoung Lee** and Na-Young Lee. Constituting 'Premature Girls' during the 1960s-70s in South Korea: A Gendered Regime of Sexual Efficiency. *The Journal of Asian Women* [in Korean]
2019. **Heeyoung Lee** and Na-Young Lee. Constructing the National Body: Child Development in the Postcolonial Nation-State during the 1960s-1970s. *Society and History* [in Korean]

Working Papers

Under Review

1. Matt Vogel, **Heeyoung Lee***, Byunggu (Gu) Kang, and Taylor Kaser. The Lethality of Violent Crime and the Pandemic-Era Homicide Surge (*Under Review at Science Advances*)
2. **Heeyoung Lee** and Matt Vogel. Living Near the Color Line: Boundary Ambiguity and Youth Violence across Racialized Neighborhood Contexts (Under Review at *Social Problems*)
3. Scott Schieman, Laura Upenieks, and **Heeyoung Lee**. For God and Company: Religion and the Centrality of Work (Under Review at *Sociology of Religion: A Quarterly Review*)
4. **Heeyoung Lee** and Patricia Homan. Long-Term Effect of Structural Racism on Subjective Cardiopulmonary Symptoms in the U.S. (Under Review at *Circulation*)
5. **Heeyoung Lee**. Geographic Structure of the Educational Mortality Gap in the US: Within- and Between-State Variation (Under Review at *Social Science & Medicine*)

Drafting

6. Yuna Lee and **Heeyoung Lee**. Policing at Racial Borders: Contested Boundaries and Race-Specific Enforcement in New York City (*draft available*)
7. Heeyoung Lee and Matt Vogel.
8. Kate Strully, **Heeyoung Lee**, Chris Lowenstein, and David Rehkoph. Refundable Tax Credits and Income Inequality Across the United States (*drafting*)
9. Scott Schieman, **Heeyoung Lee**, and Max Coleman. Social Distance Shock, Fallout, and Recovery: How Confidants and Loneliness Changed During and After the COVID-19 Pandemic (*drafting*)
10. Scott Schieman, Philip Badawy, and **Heeyoung Lee**. Boundaries Redefined: Work-Home Role Integration and Segmentation Before, During, and After the COVID-19

Pandemic (*drafting*)

11. **Heeyoung Lee.** Brain Drain and Brain Gain across US Counties
12. **Heeyoung Lee.** Educational Segregation and Mortality Gap
13. **Heeyoung Lee.** College Premium Within and Between Race

Teaching Experiences

2026 Fall	Adjunct Instructor, Medical Sociology, Sociology, University at Albany, SUNY
2026 Spring	Adjunct Instructor, Medical Sociology, Sociology, University at Albany, SUNY [4.77/5.00]
2026 Spring	Adjunct Instructor, Criminology, Sociology, University at Albany, SUNY [4.68/5.00]
2025 Fall	Adjunct Instructor, Medical Sociology, Sociology, University at Albany, SUNY [4.81/5.00]
2025 Fall	Adjunct Instructor, Criminology, Sociology, University at Albany, SUNY [4.73/5.00]
2025 Summer	Teaching Assistant, The 12th KOSTAT-UNFPA Summer Seminar on Population, Instructor: Scott Yabiku (Sociology, Penn State University)
2025 Summer	Adjunct Instructor, Criminology, Sociology, University at Albany, SUNY [4.75/5.00]
2025 Spring	Adjunct Instructor, Medical Sociology, Sociology, University at Albany, SUNY [4.76/5.00]
2024 Fall	Adjunct Instructor, Medical Sociology, Sociology, University at Albany, SUNY [4.78/5.00]
2024 Summer	Adjunct Instructor, Medical Sociology, Sociology, University at Albany, SUNY [4.80/5.00]
2023 Spring	Co-Instructor, Statistics for Sociologists, Instructor: Kate Strully (Sociology, University at Albany, SUNY)

Survey Projects

2026.	2026 Measuring Employment Sentiments and Social Inequality (PI: Scott Schieman)
2026.	Labor Rights and Discrimination of Sexual and Gender Minorities (PI: Seong-Jo Jeong)
2024.	2023 Sexual Harassment in the Film Industry Survey (PI: Na-Young Lee)
2021.	2020 Sexual Harassment in the Film Industry Survey (PI: Na-Young Lee)
2019.	Youth's Attitude Towards Gender (PI: Na-Young Lee)

Awards, Grants, Scholarships

2026.	Howard B. Kaplan Memorial Award, ASA Section on Medical Sociology
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- 2025. Hak-Bong Research Grant, School of Law, Seoul National University
- 2024. BIPOC Junior Scholar Travel Grant, ASA Section on Aging and the Life Course
- 2024. Paul Meadows, Excellence in Research Award Winner, Sociology Department, University at Albany, SUNY
- 2024. Korean Student Research Award Winner, Sociology Department, Chung-Ang University
- 2022. Democracy Academic Paper Award Winner, People's Solidarity for Participatory Democracy
- 2022. Paul Meadows, Excellence in Research Award Winner, Sociology Department, University at Albany, SUNY
- 2021. Academic Paper Contest Winner, Korean Democracy Foundation

Conference Presentations

- 2026. Early Exposure to Structural Racism and Cardiopulmonary Symptoms in Midlife in the United States, Population Association of America (PAA) 2026 Annual Meeting, Paper Session, St. Louis, May 8.
- 2026. Refundable Tax Credits and Income Inequality Across the United States, Population Association of America (PAA) 2026 Annual Meeting, Paper Session, St. Louis, May 9.
- 2025. Spatial Spillover Effect of State Policy Liberalism and Mortality in the U.S., 120th ASA Annual Meeting, Paper Session, Chicago, Aug 9.
- 2024. Racialized Cumulative Effect of Early Neighborhood Disadvantage on Mental Health Paradox, 119th ASA Annual Meeting, Paper Session, Montreal, Aug 11.
- 2024. Stress among Sexual Minorities in South Korea: An Analysis of Internalized Homophobia and Community Connectedness, 18th International Stress Conference, Portland, June. 8.
- 2023. What Did I Come Out For? Coming Out Network and Its Adverse Effects Among South Korean LGBTQ Youth, 118th ASA Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, Aug 19.
- 2023. Reciprocal risks of psychological distress between immigrant mothers and children in South Korea, Eastern Sociological Society Conference 2023, Baltimore, Feb 25.
- 2022. Moving Apart and Coming Together: The Dynamics of Coalition Building in the Case of the South Korean LGBT Movement, 117th ASA Annual Meeting, Roundtable, Los Angeles, Aug 5.
- 2021. Moving Apart and Coming Together: The Dynamics of Coalition Building in the Case of the South Korean LGBT Movement. 2021 Korean Sociological Association Annual, Academic Conference, Online, Dec. 18.

Professional Services and Activities

Peer-Review

Social Science and Medicine - Mental Health; Social Science and Research; Population Research and Policy Review; Socius; Society and Mental Health; Sociology of Race and Ethnicity;

American Journal of Preventive Medicine Focus; Journal of Homosexuality

Memberships

Present	Member, American Sociological Association (ASA) Section on Medical Sociology Section on Aging and Life Course Section on Population
Present	Member, Population Association of America (PAA)
Present	Member, International Sociological Association (ISA)
Present	Member, Korean Sociological Association (KSA)
2023-2025	Founding Member, Quantitative Research Group (QRG) in Sociology Department at the University at Albany, SUNY

Skills

R, STATA, PYTHON, SPSS, SAS, JAMOVI, ArcGIS, GeoDa, UCINET (NetDraw)

References

Tse-Chuan Yang
Professor, Sociology, University at Albany,
SUNY

Jonathan Dirlam
Assistant Professor, Sociology, University at
Albany, SUNY

Scott Schieman
Professor, Sociology, University of Toronto

Kate Strully
Associate Professor, Sociology, University at
Albany, SUNY

Matt Vogel
Associate Professor, Criminal Justice,
University at Albany, SUNY

Patricia Homan
Associate Professor, Sociology, Florida State
University